# SE 216 – SOFTWARE PROJECT MANAGEMENT
# Spring 2025-2026
# Project Proposal

## A Secure Social Marketplace & Commission Platform

### Problem Definition

Many freelance creators (artists, developers, etc.) and clients face severe communication breakdowns, trust issues, and discoverability challenges in custom commission processes. Vague client requests often lead to repeating conversations that lead to nowhere. Additionally, new creators struggle to gain visibility on traditional platforms. Furthermore, the lack of a secure and universal payment ecosystem exposes both parties to fraud, such as catfishing or unpaid labor, making the freelance ecosystem unreliable.

### Background Information

Commissions are formal requests where a client hires a creator to make a custom, one-of-a-kind piece of artwork or product based on specific requirements. The creator economy relies heavily on custom commissions, yet the current workflow is highly fragmented. Creators typically use multiple social media platforms for visibility and to negotiate requirements, and external links for payments. This disjointed approach creates an environment prone to misunderstandings and scams, as none of these platforms offer security for the entirety of the process.

To start with, it is not uncommon for some creators to try to claim AI-generated works as their own handmade products, and even use other people's work to train AI without their knowledge or permission. Most social media platforms refuse to address this problem, and some even put AI enhancement on content shared without informing the creator. This untrustworthy environment causes distress to both the creators and clients. Another issue is with the vague requests from clients who lack the knowledge to give proper information about their order. As a result, creators are forced to ask or answer the same questions to different clients over and over again, which often leads to misunderstandings and even the client deciding not to place the order. Lastly, using external links for payments can get messy if the client and the creator can not agree on which platform to make the transaction on. Common tools used for transactions by the community in some countries are often unavailable in others, which makes international commissions hard to deal with.

A unified platform that combines a secure social discovery feed, structured order forms that can be customized by the seller, and an escrow-based payment system is essential. By standardizing the request process and securing funds, the platform can eliminate communication chaos and build a trust-based ecosystem for creators.

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## Objectives

**Trust & Transparency:** To provide a trustworthy environment for creators and clients by eliminating fraud and unauthorized AI usage.

**Communication Efficiency:** To reduce communication complexity by replacing informal, fragmented negotiations with a structured, form-based ordering system.

**Creator Discoverability:** To improve creator discoverability beyond generic, fragmented social media searches.

**Financial Security:** To ensure complete financial security for all parties involved in commission transactions.

**Content Protection:** To protect original creative works from unauthorized AI training and misuse.

**Scalability:** To deliver a robust and scalable platform capable of supporting a growing creator economy.

**Advanced Filtering:** To implement a structured filtering system using specific creator attributes to achieve faster

## Approval Signatures and GitHub Accounts

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